

Essay Types — Comparison Table

Definition · Structure · Key Connectors · Example Topics

Essay Type	Definition	Structure	Key Connectors	Example Topic
Narrative <i>Tells a story</i>	Tells a personal or fictional story with a clear sequence of events, characters, and a point or lesson at the end.	Intro: Set the scene / hook the reader Body 1: Rising action / key events Body 2: Climax / turning point Conclusion: Resolution + reflection	<i>First... then... suddenly... finally... looking back...</i>	"The day I learned to ride a bike"
Descriptive <i>Paints a picture</i>	Creates a vivid sensory picture of a person, place, object, or experience using detailed, imaginative language.	Intro: Introduce the subject broadly Body 1: Visual / physical details Body 2: Sounds, smells, mood, atmosphere Conclusion: Overall impression / significance	<i>It looks... it feels like... one can smell... the atmosphere is...</i>	"Describe your hometown at night"
Argumentative <i>Persuades & debates</i>	Takes a clear stance on a controversial issue and supports it with logical reasoning and evidence, while addressing opposing views.	Intro: Hook + thesis (your position) Body 1-2: Arguments supporting your view Body 3: Counterargument + rebuttal Conclusion: Restate stance + call to action	<i>Critics argue... however... this is flawed because... clearly... therefore...</i>	"Should social media be banned for under-16s?"
Compare & Contrast <i>Finds similarities & differences</i>	Examines two or more subjects by highlighting their similarities and differences to draw a meaningful conclusion.	Intro: Introduce both subjects + thesis Body 1: Point-by-point OR subject-by-subject Body 2: Similarities / differences continued Conclusion: Which is better / what we learn	<i>Similarly... on the other hand... in contrast... both... whereas... unlike...</i>	"Online learning vs. traditional classroom"
Cause & Effect <i>Explains why & what follows</i>	Explains why something happens (causes) and/or what happens as a result (effects). Can focus on causes only, effects only, or both.	Intro: Introduce the phenomenon + thesis Body 1: First cause/effect (e.g. economic) Body 2: Second cause/effect (e.g. social) Conclusion: Summary + broader implication	<i>leads to... results in... as a result... consequently... due to... therefore...</i>	"Why are cities becoming overcrowded?"

Source: Cause/Effect Essay reference material · English Writing Skills